

2nd October 2026

Dear family and prayer partners ❤️

I meant to send out an update sooner, but we are already heading back home! It has been busy but in the middle of all the busyness, I keep thinking that what we have done feels like less than a drop in the ocean. The harvest is gigantic. There are so many lost souls and so many neglected children who are raising themselves, desperately in need of the love of Christ - the love that we know can make all the difference.

Honestly, it makes me feel like we should have started 25 years ago!

We are realising that we needed a longer trip, and even more labourers, but we are thankful that the Lord can use, even us. 🙏

WEEK 1

Because of some delays with paperwork, we eventually left Tembisa at 4am on Friday, 19 September. We had a bit of an adventure along the way when the Combi got stuck in Bloemfontein. Thankfully, I was able to tow Don to the next garage, but we ended up with a 4–5-hour delay. The kids were amazing and simply saw it all as part of the adventure! 😊

We eventually arrived in Pacaltsdorp at around 4am, where the Katts family welcomed us so warmly. They even had a meal waiting for us at that hour!

Within just a few hours, we were already serving. We started with Sunday School, where Nathan shared a message from Ephesians 6:1. The group did special music, Don preached in the main service, and later we went out on a track drive. The children then enjoyed some time at the beach from 5–7pm.

From Monday to Wednesday, we held AWANA in the local park. On the first day we had around 30 children, and each day the numbers increased until we had almost double that number!

We prepared a little meal for the children on our final day (Vienna's and chutney rolls). Each evening after supper, we had devotions together, followed by a time of fellowship, sharing and reflecting on the day.

I prepared all the meals for our group, and I am so thankful for the incredible way the Lord provided. He provided not only for our team but also for our host family. We ate well and always had enough.

On Wednesday evening we had a Bible study where the group sang and Don preached. After that, we headed to the hostel at George High School, where we stayed until Monday, 28 September.

Thursday the group went on a hike, followed by a Bible study in George.

Friday we had some fun with paintball and then prepared for the Youth Programme. The group went around the surrounding area inviting teenagers, and that evening we had games, music and a message from Don. It was a wonderful time together.

By Saturday, some of the youth were becoming sick and tired, so we kept the Sabbath and had a quieter day. Sunday morning started with drama. Some of our children were still under the weather, and then, one of the boys had his shoes stolen by a man we had just fed. It really dampened the mood but once again, the Lord reminded us that He is in control.

We attended a church service in George where our group sang and Don preached, followed by a meal at Pastor Crane's home.

By the time we were ready to leave, someone had given some money towards replacing the stolen shoes, but the Lord had another plan!

The security at the school had gone after the man once we had left and managed to recover the shoes! The owner was very happy to have his shoes back. 😊

It was another reminder that God sees everything, even the things that seem small to us. Monday was spent doing the group's washing. Even with three tumble dryers, it was quite a process!

We eventually left for Cape Town at around 14:30, we arrived in the Strand at 19:30 where we were warmly welcomed by the church, with supper waiting for us.

The group was then divided among different family homes, which meant we didn't have to spend money on accommodation. Once again, we could see God's provision through His people. And so **Week 1** of ministry came to an end.

2Co 1:11 Ye also helping together by prayer for us, that for the gift bestowed upon us by the means of many persons thanks may be given by many on our behalf.

Much love and appreciation for each of you ❤️

Donovan and Noluthando May

